

POLICY ON TREE PLANTING AND CAMPUS GREENING INITIATIVES

Rationale

The University of Mindanao affirms its commitment to ecological stewardship, biodiversity conservation and climate resilience by promoting responsible and sustainable environmental care initiatives in compliance to RA 10176 (Arbor Day Act) and Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) Administrative Order No. 2010-11.

This policy on tree planting and campus greening seeks to strengthen the University's goal to enhance environmental integrity through activities such as mandatory tree planting for students and employees, campus tree conservation programs, and the protection of native and endemic species. Through these initiatives, the University fosters a culture of environmental responsibility and contributes to the collective efforts toward climate change mitigation and ecological restoration.

Scope

This policy applies to all members of the University of Mindanao community which may include partner communities, organizations, and networks to get involved in tree planting and related greening activities. It covers all initiatives directed towards the preservation, conservation and restoration of the environment and biodiversity, either conducted within University premises or in designated off-campus areas under University-sponsored or partnered programs.

Guiding Principles

Sustainability. Tree planting and greening initiatives shall promote long-term ecological balance, biodiversity conservation, and adaptation to climate change.

Stewardship. All members of the University community and its stakeholders share responsibility in protecting and nurturing trees and species to ensure their growth and survival.

Community Engagement. Tree planting and environmental programs shall be integrated into the University's extension, instruction, and research initiatives to foster environmental awareness, stewardship and social responsibility.

Compliance

All university members and stakeholders shall comply with this policy. Non-compliance or unauthorized cutting or removal of trees or destruction of ecosystems within University shall be subject to disciplinary or administrative actions in accordance with existing University and environmental regulations

Implementation and Review

The implementation of this policy shall be spearheaded by the Community Extension Center in collaboration with the Environmental Management Office, Campus Administrators, and concerned academic units. These offices shall oversee planning, coordination, and documentation of all tree planting and campus green activities in compliance with government laws, regulations and standards as well as University guidelines.

In addition, specific operational activities such as site preparation, seedling selection, plant watering, fertilization, pruning, and monitoring shall be carried out by the responsible colleges or department, with technical guidance from accredited environmental partners or government agencies.

This policy shall be reviewed every three (3) years or as deemed necessary to ensure its continued relevance to environmental legislation, institutional priorities, and sustainability goals.

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President

References

Republic Act RA 10176 or the Arbor Day Act
Department of Environmental and Natural Resources (DENR) Administrative Order No. 2010-11